

CSCCE

About the Center



The Center for Scientific Collaboration and Community Engagement (CSCCE) is a research and training center to support and study the emerging field of scientific community engagement.

CSCCE is a fiscally sponsored project of [Community Initiatives](#), a registered 501(c)3 non-profit organization based in California, USA.

How CSCCE is funded

In 2017 and 2019, CSCCE received grants from the Alfred P. Sloan Foundation, which enabled us to establish the [Community Engagement Fellows Program](#) (CEFP) and develop our initial curriculum for scientific community managers. This funding also supported us as we developed our consulting and research services.

In 2021, CSCCE received a [grant from the Sloan Foundation](#) to test a prototype financial sustainability model. While we were already bring in significant revenue from consulting (including grant subcontracts) and training courses, this 2.5-year Sloan grant bridged the gap to sustainability while we shored up our technical infrastructure, and developed and launched additional training options.

In 2023, we received a grant from the Chan Zuckerberg Initiative to develop [Birdaro](#), supporting those in decision-making positions in scientific open-source projects as they navigate growth, scaling, and sustainability of their projects. Since then, we also expanded our training offerings, working with several new clients, and launched our Certification Program. You can find a [recap of CSCCE's 2025](#) outputs on our blog, and you can find more information about [CSCCE's current training offerings here](#).

You can support CSCCE's work as an individual by making a one-time or recurring donation via our [donate page](#).

Please contact info@cscce.org with any questions and to discuss additional ways to support our work.

CSCCE's advisory board

Our advisory board is composed of three core members who bring a range of perspectives to CSCCE – including academic research, social sciences theory, technical infrastructure implementation, facilitation, academic publishing, and business management. Thanks to their deep expertise, they span organizational contexts from academia to non-profits, business to startups. They have each been involved with scientific community-building for several years – managing, supporting and/or studying communities.

In the coming months we plan to create additional leadership roles in the CSCCE community to further represent the diverse range of members that CSCCE serves. More details will be forthcoming.

AMBER BUDDEN

Amber is an inaugural fellow of the AAAS Community Engagement Fellowship Program (CEFP) and a current CEFP mentor.



Amber Budden is an open science facilitator, community manager and data literacy trainer based at the National Center for Ecological Analysis and Synthesis. Co-lead of DataONE and the Arctic Data Center, her focus is on data science infrastructure and in supporting community development and adoption of open science learning and best practices.

Amber's previous research activity includes bibliometrics, publication practices and behavioral ecology. She served as a member of the Board of Directors for the National Postdoctoral Association during its inception, chairing the strategic planning and publications committees.

She has a PhD in behavioral ecology from the University of Wales, a joint BSc in Psychology and Zoology from the University of Bristol and is qualified as a youth and community worker. Her postdoctoral

research was conducted through the University of California, Berkeley and the University of California, Santa Barbara.

JOSH FREEMAN

Josh has been involved with CSCCE since its inception – including participating in strategic planning meetings and attending the CEEP2017 fellowship trainings.



Josh Freeman was the Founding General Manager of Trellis, the online collaboration platform for the scientific community built and operated by AAAS, and also was the co-Principal Investigator on the initial grants from the Sloan Foundation that created and funded CSCCE. In addition, Josh has been Chief Digital Media Officer for *Science*, led several start-ups, and served in a variety of roles at the Discovery Networks, AOL, and Bain & Co.

CAMERON NEYLON

Cameron served as a CEEP curriculum advisory committee member and CEEP2017 mentor.



Cameron Neylon is Professor of Research Communication at the Centre for Culture and Technology at Curtin University, Director of KU Research, and an advocate of open research practice who has worked in research and support areas including chemistry, advocacy, policy, technology, publishing, political economy and cultural studies.

He was a contributor to the Panton Principles for Open Data, the Principles for Open Scholarly Infrastructure, the altmetrics manifesto, a founding board member of FORCE11 and served on the boards and advisory boards of organisations including Impact Story, Crossref, altmetric.com, the LSE Impact Blog and various editorial boards. His previous positions include Advocacy Director at PLOS, Senior Scientist (Biological Sciences) at the STFC and tenured faculty at the University of Southampton.

Along with his earlier work in structural biology and biophysics his research and writing focuses on the culture of researchers, the political economy of research institutions and how these interact, and collide with, the changing technology environment.